

1. Why did you choose the dataset you used for your EDA? What about the context of the data interested you? What relationships did you expect to find among your variables of interest?

I chose the dataset I used for my EDA because I was interested in understanding the inequities in healthcare access and outcomes. I wanted to see how patient demographics, and states related to access to hospital care. I expected to find that patients from states with more marginalized communities would be receiving fewer resources and have access to less hospitals.

2. What challenges did you face while completing the assignment, and how did you overcome those challenges? What do you plan to do differently next time as a result? List at least one specific thing you learned about yourself as a data science student as a result.

A major challenge I had while completing this assignment was cleaning the data, since some columns had missing or inconsistent values. I overcame this using R functions like `na.omit()`, and other filtering methods. I also checked that numeric conversions were done correctly. Another challenge was interpreting certain categorical variables. Next time I plan to document the data cleaning steps more thoroughly to save time, and I learned from this experience that every little detail is very crucial when it comes to working with real world and heavy data sets.

3. Describe at least one way your personal background influenced how you analyzed this data or presented your analysis. What might someone else have done differently if analyzing the same dataset?

My personal background and interest in equity and social justice influenced the focus of my analysis. I paid special attention to disparities by race, because I'm interested in how our everyday society is still facing the effects of racist practices such as redlining and gentrification. Someone else analyzing the same dataset might have focused solely on clinical outcomes or hospital efficiency, and I centered it more so on the equity aspects and access issues. My personal experiences and awareness of systemic inequities allowed me to consider additional variables and frame the results in a way that would highlight real world implications for underserved communities.